

4.10 GRADE DESCRIPTIONS

Grade descriptions are provided to give a general indication of the standards of achievement likely to have been shown by the candidates awarded particular grades. The descriptions must be interpreted in relation to the content specified in Sub-section 5; they are not designed to define that content. The grade awarded will depend in practice upon the extent to which the candidate has met the assessment objectives overall. Shortcomings in some aspects of the assessment may be balanced by better performance in others.

Grade F

Candidates recall and recognise some psychological structures, models or processes outlined in the specification and give a partial description of them. They show a basic understanding of, and apply in a superficial way, a few psychological concepts, terms and theories. They recognise and describe relevant psychological issues or debates.

Candidates use a limited range of methods, sources, information and data uncritically and in a simple manner to find out about psychological issues or topics. They demonstrate a limited ability to interpret information, make judgements and reach conclusions.

Grade C

Candidates recall, describe and give a partial analysis of a variety of psychological structures, models or processes outlined in the specification. They show understanding of, and apply a variety of, psychological concepts, terms and theories. They recognise and describe relevant psychological issues or debates and select appropriate arguments in relation to the issues, theories and evidence. They make straightforward links between psychological structures, processes and issues.

Candidates use a range of methods, sources, information and data to find out about psychological issues or topics and can indicate why they were chosen. They handle and evaluate information and data to make reasonable judgements and present plausible conclusions which are supported by relevant evidence.

Grade A

Candidates deploy a breadth of relevant knowledge to produce substantiated analyses and explanations of a variety of psychological structures, models or processes outlined in the specification. They show precise understanding of, and apply accurately, appropriate psychological concepts, terms and theories. They recognise appropriate psychological issues or debates, substantiate them with evidence and reach valid conclusions. They analyse links between psychological structures, processes and issues.

Candidates identify and use appropriate methods, sources, information and data for a particular purpose and justify their selection. They interpret information and data presented in a variety of forms; critically evaluate its relevance in relation to the arguments and reach substantiated conclusions.